



THE WERATREAN ARCHIVE

No. 5518

TOLL AT THE OLD MILESTONE

One bandit. One bad plan. Your next roadside encounter.



TOLL AT THE OLD MILESTONE

GM briefing: 3–4 level 1 characters · 10–20 minutes · 5E (2014). A very easy fight against a single foe, intended as a brief roadside encounter. Both language editions use feet (5 ft. equals 1.5 m).

INTRODUCTION

A man in battered leather armor steps onto the woodland road beside a weathered milestone. He raises his crossbow. “Two gold pieces each, and you reach the village in one piece.” His eyes dart nervously between your weapons.

The bandit **Jorek** needs money and overestimates how intimidating he looks. He stands 30 ft. ahead of the party on a road 10 ft. wide. There are no hidden accomplices. If the characters pay, he lets them pass. A credible offer of help and a successful **DC 12 Charisma (Persuasion) check** convince him to stand down. If negotiations fail or the party walks past without paying, he attacks.

COMBAT

Roll initiative before Jorek fires. His open threat leaves no one surprised. He fires his light crossbow at the lead character and stays beside the milestone. The stone grants half cover (+2 AC and Dexterity saving throws) against attacks from the opposite side of the road; characters can move around it to deny him that cover.

In melee, Jorek draws his scimitar. At **5 hit points or fewer**, he drops his weapons and surrenders. He never pursues fleeing characters and will not fight to the death. Use the unchanged SRD bandit stat block; Jorek’s name, motivation, and behavior are specific to this encounter.

AFTERMATH

Jorek carries **7 silver pieces**, his weapons, and a heel of stale bread. Characters who accept his surrender can hand him over to the village watch or release him after he promises to leave travelers alone. Those who paid reach the village unharmed. If Jorek escaped, only the empty milestone remains.

Award **25 XP to the party**, divided equally, once for defeating him, talking him down, or otherwise resolving the threat, or use your usual milestone advancement. This concludes the encounter.

JOREK, THE HIGHWAYMAN

Jorek talks too loudly to hide his fear. His cloak smells of damp leaves, but his crossbow is well maintained. He wants coins and a full stomach, not bodies. Once he surrenders, he answers simple questions honestly: he works alone, has no employer, and has no secret hideout.

GNOLL

Medium, humanoid, chaotic evil

Armor Class 15

Hit Points 22 (5W8)

Speed 9m

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14	12	11	6	10	7
(+2)	(+1)	(+0)	(-2)	(+0)	(-2)

Senses Dunkelsicht 18m, Passive Wahrnehmung 10

Languages Gnollisch

Challenge 1/2

TRAITS

Wüten. Wenn ein Gnoll eine Kreatur im Nahkampf in seinem Zug auf 0. Trefferpunkte bringt, kann der Gnoll eine Bonusaktion ausführen, um sich bis zu seine halbe Bewegungsrate zu bewegen und einen Biss-Angriff auszuführen.

ACTIONS

Biss. Nahkampf-Waffenangriff | +4 zum Treffen, Reichweite 1,5m, eine Kreatur. Treffer | 4 (1W4+2) Stichschaden.

Speer. Nahkampf- oder Fernkampf-Waffenangriff | +4 zum Treffen, Reichweite 1,5m oder Reichweite 6 18m (Fernkampf), ein Ziel. Treffer | 5 (1W6+2) Stichschaden, oder 6 (1W8+2) Stichschaden, wenn die Waffe mit beiden Händen für einen Nahkampfangriff verwendet wird.

Langbogen. Fernkampf-Waffenangriff | +3 zum Treffen, Reichweite 45 180m, ein Ziel. Treffer | 5 (1W8+1) Stichschaden.

SOURCES AND CREDITS

Rules data: System Reference Document 5.1, D&D 5e (2014), p. 397 (Gnoll). CC BY 4.0.

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Eigene deutsche Übersetzung und neues Layout; Regelwerte unverändert. Entfernungen bleiben in Fuß. Jorek und die Begegnung sind neue Inhalte.

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